

Tracking Link - Agent Knowledge Base

How to interpret shipment tracking, missing or invalid links, first-scan delays, split shipments, and delivered-not-received contacts.

Prototype disclaimer

Synthetic sample policy for prototyping and RAG evaluation. This document is fictional operational guidance, not a statement of any real company's policy. Adapt, validate, and approve it before production use.

Retrieval metadata

Applies to: customer support agents, ticket triage agents, and automated support agents

Recommended ticket tags: tracking_link, label_created, no_scan, delivered_not_received, split_shipment

Policy status: synthetic / test corpus

Policy summary

A tracking link becomes available only after the carrier has accepted the shipment record. The first tracking event may lag behind the shipment email. Agents should separate "label created" from "carrier in possession" and should not interpret a missing scan as proof that a package is lost.

Core rule

Use the carrier status and event timestamp as the operational source of truth. The customer-facing ETA is an estimate unless the carrier explicitly guarantees a service level.

Decision rules

Situation	Agent action	Escalate when
Tracking link not yet present	Check whether the order is fulfilled. If not fulfilled, advise customer to wait for shipment confirmation.	Order is marked shipped for more than 24 hours with no tracking reference.
Link exists but shows "label created"	Explain that the carrier may not have scanned the parcel yet. Allow up to 48 hours for the first physical scan.	No physical scan after 48 hours.
Tracking link returns an error	Verify the carrier and tracking number. Try the canonical carrier tracking page if available.	Number is rejected by the carrier after 24 hours.
Tracking shows delivered but customer cannot find package	Ask customer to check household members, mailroom, parcel locker, safe place, and neighbors. Allow up to 24 hours for a premature delivery scan.	Still missing after 24 hours or delivery location appears incorrect.
Tracking has no movement	If there is no carrier event for 3 business days after initial movement, classify as stalled and use carrier_delay policy.	Shipment exceeds delay thresholds or carrier reports an exception.

Agent workflow

- Confirm order ID and destination postal code.
- Identify shipment count; multi-item orders may have multiple tracking links.
- Read the latest event, location, timestamp, and ETA.
- Explain the current state in plain language and give the next check time.

Common tracking states

Label created = shipping information transmitted but carrier possession not confirmed. In transit = carrier has accepted the parcel and it is moving through the network. Out for delivery = parcel is on a local delivery route. Exception = carrier reports an event that may delay or prevent delivery. Delivered = carrier recorded a final delivery scan.

Suggested ticket fields

issue_type=tracking; order_id; shipment_id; carrier; tracking_number_last6; latest_status; latest_event_time; promised_eta_if_any; customer_claim=missing_link|invalid_link|no_scan|delivered_not_received

Frequently asked questions

Q: Where is my tracking link?

A: Tracking appears after a shipment is created. If the order has not shipped, there may be no link yet. If it has been marked shipped for more than 24 hours with no tracking reference, escalate.

Q: Why does tracking say "label created" for so long?

A: The label can be created before the carrier performs its first physical scan. Allow up to 48 hours, then escalate if no scan appears.

Q: The tracking page says delivered, but I do not have the package.

A: Ask the customer to check common handoff locations and wait up to 24 hours for a premature scan to resolve. If still missing, open a delivered-not-received investigation.

Q: Can you give me a more exact delivery time?

A: Use only the carrier-provided window. Agents should not invent a delivery hour or guarantee an estimate.

Q: My order has two tracking numbers. Is that normal?

A: Yes. Multi-item orders can ship in separate parcels from different facilities.

Q: The tracking number says invalid.

A: Confirm that the right carrier site is being used and allow up to 24 hours after shipment creation. Escalate if the carrier still rejects the number.

Agent response principle

State what is known, distinguish it from what is estimated, give the customer the next concrete step, and never promise an outcome outside the rules in this knowledge base.